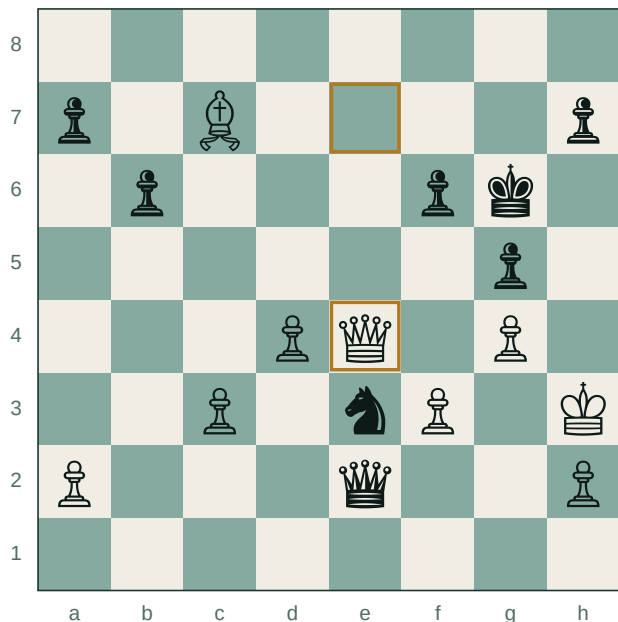


# Active defensive resources: Black, move 36

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 36.Qe4+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**36...Kh6 37. Qxe3 Qxe3**

**36...Kh6** The king moves from g6 to h6. Recorded reply: **37.Qxe3**.

**37...Qxe3** The queen captures the queen on e3.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -1 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on h3. Geometrically undefended: bishop on c7. Check for tactical protection.